

Figurative Language & Literary Devices — Part 1

Name: _____

Date: _____

Time: 60 min

1 · COPY THIS DOWN — NOTES, STRUCTURES & TECHNIQUE

DEFINITIONS — COPY THE TABLE

DEVICE	DEFINITION
Simile	Compares two things using "like" or "as"
Metaphor	Describes one thing directly as another (no "like/as")
Personification	Gives human qualities to something non-human
Symbolism	An object represents a bigger idea (e.g. a wilting flower = fading hope)
Hyperbole	Deliberate, obvious exaggeration for effect

TECHNIQUE — 4 STEPS TO EXPLAIN ANY DEVICE

1. Name the device
2. Quote the exact phrase
3. State the literal meaning vs. the figurative/implied meaning
4. Link it to the mood, character, or theme it creates

SENTENCE FRAME TO COPY

"The writer uses [device] in the phrase '____', which literally means ____ but suggests ____, creating a sense of ____."

2 · PRACTICE — 4 PASSAGES, 20 QUESTIONS

EXTRACT A

The old dog moved like a rusted hinge, every step a small complaint.

1. Identify the device used in "moved like a rusted hinge."

2. What literal image does this create?

3. What does it suggest about the dog's condition?

4. Identify a second device in "every step a small complaint."

5. Write a full explanation using the sentence frame.

EXTRACT B

Anger was a fire in her chest that refused to be put out, no matter how many times she told herself to calm down.

6. Identify the device used in "anger was a fire."

7. Why is this a metaphor and not a simile?

8. What does "refused to be put out" add to the metaphor?

9. What mood does this create for the reader?

10. Write a full explanation using the sentence frame.

EXTRACT C

The wind slammed the door shut before anyone could stop it, as if it had somewhere urgent to be.

11. Identify the device in "the wind slammed the door... as if it had somewhere urgent to be."

12. What human quality is given to the wind?

13. What effect does this create — calm or dramatic?

14. Could this also be read as foreshadowing? Explain.

15. Write a full explanation using the sentence frame.

EXTRACT D

She had told him a thousand times not to leave his boots by the door, and yet there they were again, tripping her for the thousandth time.

16. Identify the device in "a thousand times" / "thousandth time."

17. Is this meant to be taken literally?

18. What effect does this exaggeration create — humour or seriousness?

19. What does the repetition of "thousand" suggest about the pattern in their relationship?

20. Write a full explanation using the sentence frame.

Apply this every time: Never just name a device — always quote it, explain literal vs figurative meaning, and link it to mood or theme. A device named with no explanation earns no marks.

MARKING NOTES (FOR THE TUTOR)

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. Simile | 5. Model using frame |
| 2. A stiff, creaking movement | 6. Metaphor |
| 3. Old, worn out, in discomfort | 7. No "like/as" used — direct comparison |
| 4. Personification (a step "complaining") | 8. Suggests the anger is ongoing, hard to control |

- 9. Tense, uneasy mood
- 10. Model using frame
- 11. Personification
- 12. Urgency/intention
- 13. Dramatic
- 14. Yes — could hint at trouble to come

- 15. Model using frame
- 16. Hyperbole
- 17. No
- 18. Humour, with a hint of real frustration
- 19. Suggests a long-running, repeated annoyance
- 20. Model using frame